

Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:

Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.

You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double

Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major

If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors

1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit

1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠ 3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠ J

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦ K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣ 2

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦ 3

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2 ♣
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣ 5

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5
 ♥ J 10 9 2
 ♦ A K Q 5
 ♣ J 10 3

♠ A K J 7

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ K Q 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 4 3

♥ Q 6 4

♦ J 10 3 2

♣ 9 8 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ A K 5 3

♦ 8 4

♣ A 6 2

SOUTH has both Majors and planned on bidding 1♥ first, (up-the-line). But EAST's overcall gave SOUTH the opportunity to bid both Majors at the same time! Since the Negative Double promises both Majors it was like SOUTH could bid 1♥♠.

NORTH has ♠s so she bids 1♠, showing a minimum opener.

SOUTH has 13 points and the ♠ fit so he bids game.

West	North	East	South
	1♣	1♦	Dbl
Pass	1♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♠3			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 6 2
 ♥ A 10 9 3
 ♦ 9 7
 ♣ Q 8 2

♠ 5 4 3

♥ Q 5 4

♦ Q 8 5 2

♣ 7 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 7

♥ J 8 7

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 10 4

♠ J 10 8

♥ K 6 2

♦ J 10 4 3

♣ A 9 5

WEST has 13 points and four cards in both ♥s and ♠s. Rather than bid one of them she makes a Negative Double, promising four cards in EACH of them. It's like she was able to bid 1 ♥ ♠.

EAST doesn't have four cards in either Major, but with a ♦ stopper he bids 1NT.

WEST happily bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	1 ♦
Dbl	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ J			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ Q 10 6 4
♦ A K 10 5
♣ 10 9 8

♠ A K J 7

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ K Q 5 4



♠ 10 8 4

♥ J 9 3 2

♦ Q J 3 2

♣ J 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ A K 5

♦ 8 4

♣ A 6 3 2

SOUTH cannot respond with a Negative Double on this hand because he has only three ♥s.

Instead he just bids his 4-card Major, 1 ♠.

NORTH shows 4-card support with a minimum opener by bidding 2 ♠ and SOUTH has enough strength to bid game.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	1 ♦	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ K			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 5 3 2

♥ A J 10

♦ 9 8 7

♣ A 8

♠ Q 7 4

♥ K 5 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ J 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9

♥ 8 6 2

♦ A K 6 3

♣ K Q 7 5

♠ J 8 6

♥ Q 9 7 3

♦ J 10 2

♣ 10 9 4

EAST has 15 points, and when North overcalls 2♥ in front of her she has a perfect Negative Double - showing both of the Minor suits.

WEST doesn't like the Minor suits, but he has stoppers in ♥s, so he bids 2NT.

EAST is more than happy to raise to 3NT.

West

1♠

2NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♣2

North

2♥

Pass

East

Dbl

3NT

South

Pass

Board 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 10 7 5
♣ J 9 8

♠ 9
♥ K Q J 7
♦ A K 6
♣ A Q 10 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J 7 3
♥ 10 3
♦ Q 9 3 2
♣ 7 3

♠ 10 8 6
♥ A 9 6 4 2
♦ 8 4
♣ K 6 2

SOUTH would have responded 1♥ if EAST had not overcalled. But with only 8 points he cannot bid at the 2-level. The Negative Double solves his problem, giving this information to partner.

NORTH has good ♥s and enough points to bid game. Notice that if EAST had remained silent, SOUTH would have responded 1♥, and NORTH would have jumped to game.

West	North	East	South
	1♣	1♠	
Pass	4♥		Dbl
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♦ 3			

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 6 2

♥ 9 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ Q 9 8 2

♠ J 5 4

♥ Q 6 5 2

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ A 3



♠ 10 9 7

♥ K 8 7

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 10 4

♠ Q 8 3

♥ A J 10 4

♦ J 5 4

♣ 7 6 5

WEST has four ♠s, so instead of bidding them she makes a Negative Double.

EAST knows there is no 8-card fit in ♠s, but he does have ♥s stopped. He bids 1NT.

WEST has 9 points and with four ♣s she goes back to that suit and EAST passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

1NT

Pass

2 ♣

All Pass

2 ♣ by East

Lead: ♣5